

HOW TO SEND SELF-DESTRUCTIVE MAILS VIA GMAIL'S CONFIDENTIAL MODE

Nimeesh Kumar

Once you hit Send, words written by you in an email are out of your control. Now, Gmail has come up with Confidential mode. It gives you some control, by offering message expiration dates and making it trickier for an email to be forwarded. Confidential mode does not use standard email protocols to deliver the message. Instead, an email sent through this mode is hosted on Google's servers.

Confidential mode comes with its own drawbacks. For example, if you are not viewing the email in Gmail (app), you must click on a link to open the message in a browser. This is an attempt to make an email more secure and controllable.

Installing the new interface. You can switch to the new interface by clicking on Settings on the top-right of the main page. Select Try The New Gmail option. The new interface will load automatically.

Sending emails via Confidential mode. After installing the new Gmail, click on Compose. The icon highlighted in Fig. 1 appears. If you do not click on the icon, the email will be sent in the standard format, that is, without using Confidential mode features.

After you click on the icon, the box shown in Fig. 2 appears. Here, you can set the date of expiry for your message,



Fig. 1: New icon appears on clicking Compose after activating Confidential mode

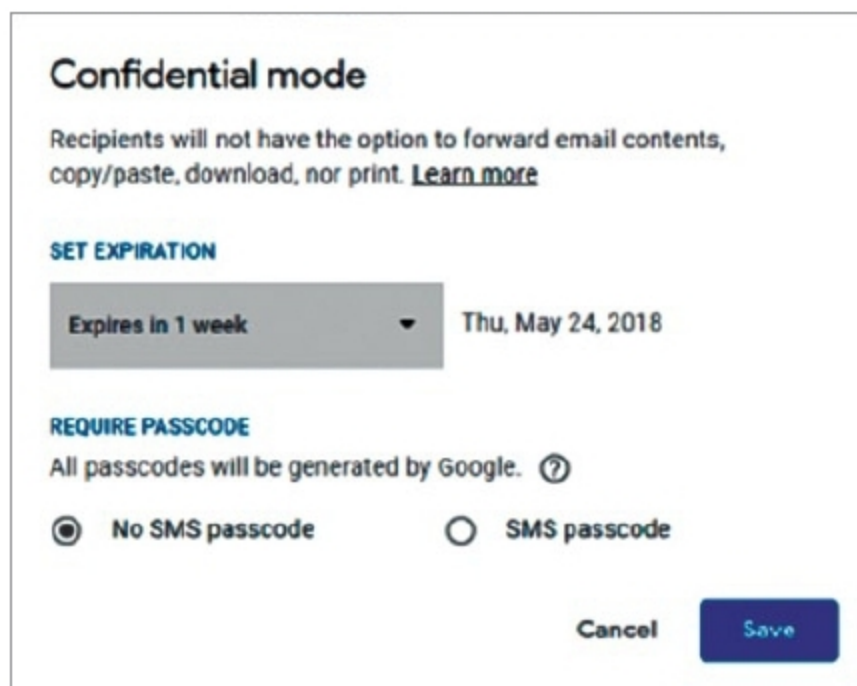


Fig. 2: Confidential mode settings

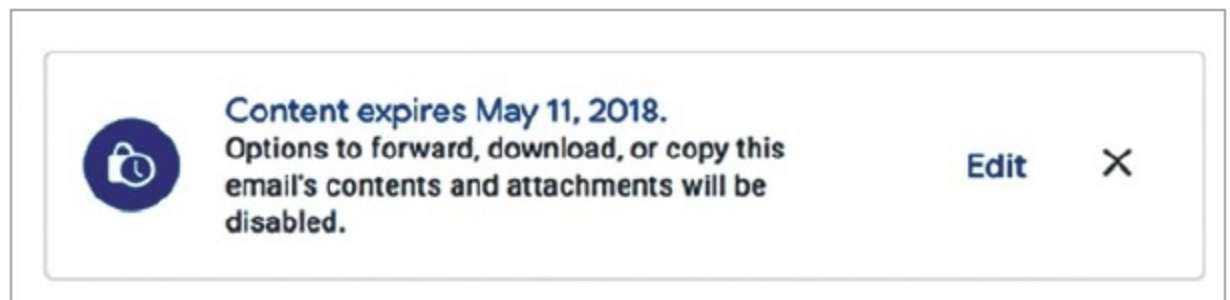


Fig. 3: Badge for Confidential mode

ranging from one day to five years.

There is an option for setting a passcode, to be sent as an SMS to the

receiver's phone number. The recipient has to use the same to access the email.